

# Hidden-state proxies outrank vocabulary readbacks in the controlled proxy audit

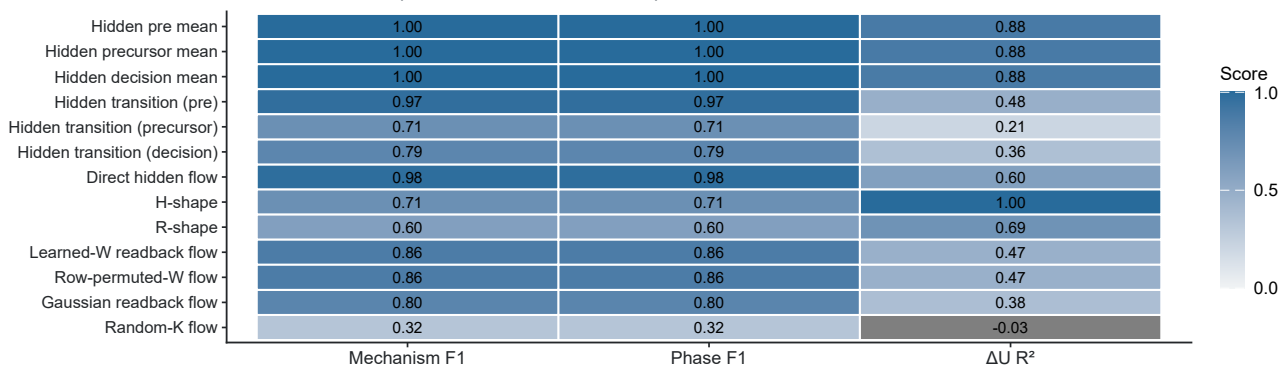
**a**



**b**

## Complete proxy ranking across checkpoints

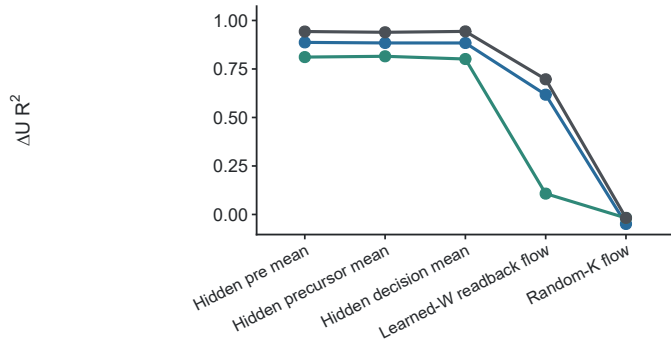
Cell values are checkpoint means; metrics remain separate



**c**

## Initial proxy audit before capacity matching

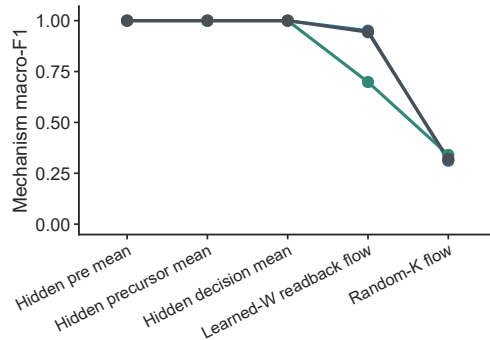
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**d**

## Mechanism-label separation

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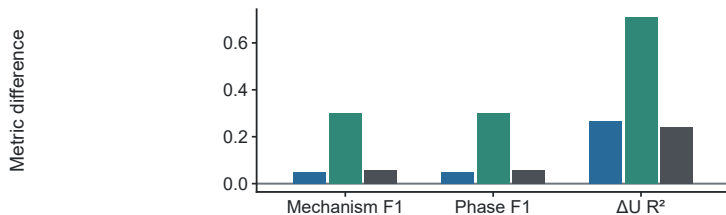


**e**

## Hidden precursor minus learned-W readback

Positive values favour the hidden-state proxy

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**f**

## Object comparison updated

### Ordered layer-state trajectory

Strict predecision + matched capacity  
reported in Supplementary Fig. S13